

Joel Leiva

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student with hands-on experience in SIEM monitoring, log analysis, and network traffic inspection leveraging Splunk, Wireshark, and OSINT techniques to identify suspicious activity and assess impact. Currently studying for the Certified Junior Cybersecurity Analyst (CJCA) certification through Hack The Box, with a strong focus on ethical, data-driven security operations.

EDUCATION

Kean University, Union, NJ

Appx. May 2027

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science: Cybersecurity

Relevant Coursework: Computer Systems, Computer Operating Systems, Foundations in Cybersecurity, Firewalls & Secure Comp Ent, Big Data Computing, Python Programming, Database Management

CERTIFICATIONS

Fortinet: FCF, FCA

Zscaler: Zero Trust Cyber Associate

PROJECTS/PROGRAMS

NCyTE Cybersecurity Career Challenge, Student

February - Present

- Managed a Proxmox-hosted, **multi-tier network** environment consisting of **10 endpoints** over VPN, facilitating routers, firewalls, web and mail servers, Active Directory/DNS, database server, and client endpoints.
- Configured firewall policy, NAT, static routing, aliases, and segmented traffic across LAN, WAN, and DMZ zones to enforce **least-privilege** network access and improve perimeter security.
- Developed and secured an internal mail server on RHEL using Postfix and Dovecot with SMTP submission, IMAPS, SASL authentication, TLS encryption, and firewall service hardening.
- Implemented AD/DNS and DHCP services to support domain authentication, IP address assignments, and internal name resolution for Windows clients.

Technical Experience

2024 - Present

- Built and maintain a **home lab** using Cat6a cabling, a network switch, Linux virtual machines (Ubuntu, Kali), and a Raspberry Pi 5 to gain hands-on experience with system administration, networking, and security testing.
- Implemented network-wide **DNS filtering** with Pi-hole on Raspberry Pi, composing threat blocklists to mitigate access to known malicious, phishing, and malware-related domains.
- Learned core **networking and security concepts** (TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP) to analyze traffic flow, troubleshoot connectivity issues, and understand defensive controls in a lab environment.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Center for Cybersecurity, Kean University, Union, NJ

September 2025 - Present

Threat Intelligence and Analyst Intern

- Perform **open-source threat intelligence** research on cyber incidents impacting nonprofit and NGO sectors, assessing ransomware, data breach, and DoS/DDoS activity to provide crucial cybersecurity information to over 60 organizations.
- Built a physical **server rack** supporting **5 devices**, including switching infrastructure, power distribution, and NVR systems, enabling stable and secure lab operations.
- Deployed a PoE-based IP camera network with 5 cameras, integrating devices through an unmanaged switch and NVR, improving monitoring coverage and hands-on experience with network traffic analysis.
- Created C.Y.B.E.R. radio talk show to increase cybersecurity awareness on campus and answer FAQs.

Division of General Education, Kean University, Union, NJ

March 2024 - December 2025

General Education Mentor

- Provided **IT support** for office workstations, peripherals, and printers, diagnosing and solving connectivity issues to maintain daily operations.
- Managed and analyzed student service data using Microsoft **Excel**, creating structured tracking sheets to facilitate reporting, workflow optimization, and operational decision-making.